

Credit - Drishti Ias

3rd India-Australia Annual Leaders' Summit 2026



For Prelims: Indian Ocean Rim Association , Traditional Knowledge Digital Library , Quad , Supply Chain Resilience Initiative , India-Australia Renewable Energy Partnership

For Mains: India-Australia Relations and Comprehensive Strategic Partnership, Measures to Enhance India-Australia Bilateral Partnership

Source: PIB

Why in News?

The Prime Minister of India visited Australia for the **3 rd India-Australia Annual Leaders' Summit (July 2026)**. The visit focused on deepening cooperation in the Indo-Pacific, securing energy and critical technology supply chains, defense collaboration, and building a durable **strategic partnership**.



Summary

- The **3rd India-Australia Annual Leaders' Summit (2026)** significantly deepened the **Comprehensive Strategic Partnership** through new initiatives in defence and maritime security, civil nuclear energy, critical technologies, resilient supply chains, space, education and people-to-people ties.
- Despite growing strategic convergence in the Indo-Pacific, relations face challenges from **strategic divergences, slow CECA negotiations, trade imbalances, China-linked critical mineral supply chains and diaspora-related tensions**, requiring deeper economic integration, defence cooperation and resilient supply chains.

What are the Key Outcomes of the 3rd India-Australia Annual Leaders' Summit?

- **Defence & Maritime Security:** The two nations formally **adopted** the **Joint Declaration on Defence and Security Cooperation (JDDSC)**. It crucially renews the existing 2009 framework and specifically identifies interoperability, cyber security, defence industrial collaboration, and a unified approach in forums like **UNCLOS**, **ASEAN**, and **Indian Ocean Rim Association (IORA)**.
 - The **Maritime Security Collaboration Roadmap (MSCR)** was launched to significantly enhance information sharing, capability development, and operational coordination in the broader maritime domain.
 - An MoU was officially signed between the **Indian Coast Guard (ICG)** and **Australia's Maritime Border Command (MBC)** primarily to strengthen maritime law enforcement and border protection.
- **Energy Security & Civil Nuclear Ties:** The **Administrative Arrangement for the 2014 India-Australia Civil Nuclear Agreement** was successfully operationalised, effectively enabling the steady supply of Australian uranium for India's growing civilian nuclear energy needs.
 - Both countries formally adopted the **India-Australia Joint Statement on Energy Security**, robustly reaffirming their mutual commitment to securing supply chains amidst ongoing global geopolitical tensions.
 - The **Rooftop Solar Training Academy** was launched at Pandit Deendayal Energy University (PDEU) in Gandhinagar, which will essentially train 2,000 women and youth as solar technicians to strongly support the **PM Surya Ghar Yojana**.
- **Technology, Innovation & Critical Minerals:** The **Australia-India Partnership for Cyber, Critical Technologies, Supply Chains (PACTS)** was **launched** to build on the 2020 framework, aiming to promote digital resilience and secure critical supply chains.
 - A trilateral MoU was jointly signed under the **Australia-Canada-India Technology and Innovation (ACITI)** Partnership to effectively advance cooperation in emerging technologies.
- **Investment: AustralianSuper** (Australia's largest superannuation fund) will deepen its commitment to **India's National Investment and Infrastructure Fund (NIIF)** with a further AUD 500 million, taking the Fund's overall holdings in India across all asset classes to AUD 3.3 billion.
- **Education, Skills & Scientific Research:** Letters of Intent/Approval were formally signed essentially permitting **Flinders University** (Bengaluru) and **Victoria University** (Gurugram) to officially set up and operate their campuses in India.

- An access agreement was **adopted** giving **IP Australia access to India's Traditional Knowledge Digital Library (TKDL)** , crucially protecting Indian systems from patent misappropriation.
- The **India-Australia Sports Collaboration Roadmap** was proactively **launched** to promote High-Performance Sports Centres, particularly focusing on sharing expertise for Para sports and the Olympics.
- **Space Cooperation:** Australia extended support to India's **Gaganyaan Mission** , including a temporary space-tracking terminal on the **Cocos (Keeling) Islands** .
- **Culture & Sports:** Australia voluntarily **announced** the repatriation of three remarkably significant **11th -12th century artifacts to India** (including a stone Nandi, a Bhadrakali trident, and a Skanda sculpture).
- The **India-Australia Sports Collaboration Roadmap** was proactively **launched** to promote High-Performance Sports Centres, particularly focusing on sharing expertise for Para sports and the Olympics.
- **Social Media Curbs for Minors:** The Indian Prime Minister hailed Australia's **social media ban on minors**.

How are India-Australia Relations?

- **High-Level Bilateral & Multilateral Architecture:** Australia stands as one of only two countries globally (alongside Japan) with which **India simultaneously conducts Annual Leader-Level Summits, maintains a functional Free Trade Agreement, and hosts a 2+2 Foreign and Defence Ministers' Dialogue**.
- **Economic and Trade Dynamics:** Since the Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement (ECTA) entered into force in **December 2022** , economic integration has intensified.
 - **India is Australia's fifth-largest trading partner.** Total two-way trade in goods and services reached **USD 50.2 billion in 2025** . For the fiscal year **2024-2025** , Australian exports totaled USD 32 billion against Indian imports of USD 18 billion.
 - In **February 2025** , Australia launched **A New Roadmap for Australia's Economic Engagement with India** , outlining four superhighways: clean energy, education, agribusiness, and tourism.
 - Both sides are fast-tracking talks to upgrade ECTA into a full **Comprehensive Economic Cooperation Agreement (CECA)** .
- **Defence and Maritime Security:** India-Australia defence cooperation has deepened under the **Comprehensive Strategic Partnership (2020)** and **Mutual Logistics Support Arrangement (2020)** , further strengthened by the **Joint Declaration on Defence and Security Cooperation (2026)** and **Maritime Security Collaboration Roadmap (2026)** .
 - Cooperation includes **submarine rescue support, maritime domain awareness, regular exercises such as Malabar , AUSINDEX and Pitch Black**, and Indian naval deployments to **Australia's strategically located Cocos (Keeling) Islands** .
 - India's participation in Australia's largest military exercise, **"Talisman Sabre 2025"** , further deepened operational ties.
- **Strategic Convergence:** Both are remarkably active members of the **Quad (Quadrilateral Security Dialogue)** and the **Supply Chain Resilience Initiative (SCRI)** , largely working towards a mutually free, open, and rules-based Indo-Pacific.
- **Renewable Energy:** The **India-Australia Renewable Energy Partnership (REP)** is a bilateral initiative launched in 2024 targeting eight cooperation areas, including solar PV, green hydrogen, battery storage, and the circular economy.

- **Education and People-to-People Links:** Nearly 976,000 people in Australia reported Indian heritage, making them the largest overseas-born group.
- In **2023** , the **Migration and Mobility Partnership Arrangement** and the **Centre for Australia-India Relations** were launched to streamline institutional mobility.
- Education remains Australia's primary service export to India, valued at **USD 9.4 billion in 2025** .

What are the Major Challenges in India-Australia Relations?

- **Strategic and Geopolitical Divergences:** Australia's security architecture is closely tied to the **US alliance system** and **AUKUS** while India follows **strategic autonomy** and **avoids formal military alliances** .
 - Their security priorities also differ, with **Australia primarily focused on maritime threats in the Western Pacific**, while India faces both continental threats along the **Line of Actual Control (LAC)** and maritime challenges in the Indian Ocean.
 - Australia's significant economic dependence on China further complicates deeper strategic alignment.
- **Economic and Trade Bottlenecks:** Despite the **ECTA** progress towards a comprehensive CECA remains slow due to Australia's demands for greater access to India's **sensitive agriculture and dairy markets** and stringent Australian **SPS standards** affecting Indian exports.
 - India's dependence on Australian coking coal and LNG also contributes to a persistent bilateral trade deficit.
- **Critical Minerals Supply Chain Constraints:** Although Australia possesses large reserves of **lithium, cobalt and rare earth elements** , limited domestic processing capacity means that much of these resources continue to depend on China-linked refining supply chains.
 - This limits India and Australia's ability to build genuinely secure and diversified critical mineral supply chains.
- **Sociopolitical and Diaspora Frictions:** Incidents involving **temple vandalism and the activities of separatist (Khalistani) elements in Australia** have created recurring diplomatic tensions.
 - India views such activities as threats to its sovereignty and territorial integrity, while differences in domestic legal approaches to freedom of expression complicate bilateral cooperation on the issue.

What Measures are Needed to Strengthen India-Australia Relations?

- **Deepen Economic Integration:** Finalise a balanced **CECA** by addressing Australian **Sanitary and Phytosanitary (SPS) barriers through Mutual Recognition Agreements (MRAs)** while protecting India's vulnerable agriculture and dairy sectors through **tariff-rate quotas and safeguard mechanisms** .
- **Build Resilient Critical Mineral Supply Chains:** Move beyond raw mineral trade towards **joint investment in refining and processing infrastructure** , leveraging the **Quad Critical Minerals Initiative (2026)** and operationalising **PACTS (2026)** to reduce dependence on China-dominated supply chains.
- **Deepen Defence and Maritime Cooperation:** Translate the **JDDSC and MSCR (2026)** into stronger underwater domain awareness, reciprocal military deployments and operational coordination.
 - Promote **joint defence R&D, technology transfer and co-production** to strengthen India's

indigenous defence capabilities.

- **Strengthen Nuclear and Energy Security:** Convert the operationalisation of the **India-Australia Civil Nuclear Agreement (2014)** into long-term uranium supply arrangements to support India's expanding nuclear energy programme and energy security.
- **Manage Diaspora and Security Concerns:** Strengthen intelligence sharing and law-enforcement cooperation to address **extremist activities, separatist (Khalistani) elements and attacks on Indian diplomatic and cultural institutions** , while ensuring the protection of diplomatic missions under international law.

Conclusion

To transform political goodwill into structural permanence, India and Australia must urgently transcend traditional tariff negotiations by **systematically dismantling non-tariff barriers and co-investing in domestic critical mineral refining infrastructure**. By actively bridging the strategic gap between **Western alliance systems and strategic autonomy through localized maritime burden-sharing** , both democracies can successfully anchor a multipolar, secure, and resilient Indo-Pacific order.

Drishti Mains Question:

India-Australia relations have evolved from mutual strategic neglect to an increasingly institutionalised Comprehensive Strategic Partnership.

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

1. What were the major outcomes of the 3rd India-Australia Annual Leaders' Summit 2026?

The summit adopted the **JDDSC, MSCR, Energy Security Joint Statement and PACTS** , operationalised the Civil Nuclear Agreement and expanded cooperation in defence, critical technologies, education, space and resilient supply chains.

2. What is the Maritime Security Collaboration Roadmap (MSCR)?

The **MSCR (2026)** is an India-Australia framework for strengthening **maritime information sharing, capability development, capacity building and operational coordination** in the Indo-Pacific.

3. What is the Australia-India Partnership on Cyber, Critical Technologies and Supply Chains (PACTS)?

PACTS (2026) strengthens cooperation in **cybersecurity, critical technologies, digital resilience, defence research and diversification of critical supply chains** .

4. What is the significance of the India-Australia Civil Nuclear Agreement?

The **2014 Civil Nuclear Agreement** , operationalised through an Administrative Arrangement in **2026** , enables long-term Australian uranium exports to India for peaceful purposes under **IAEA safeguards** .

5. What are the major challenges in India-Australia relations?

Key challenges include **strategic divergences, slow CECA negotiations, SPS barriers, bilateral trade asymmetry, China-linked critical mineral processing dependencies and tensions involving separatist (Khalistani) elements in Australia** .

UPSC Civil Services Examination, Previous Year Questions (PYQs)

Prelims

Q. In which one of the following groups are all the four countries members of G20?

- (a) Argentina, Mexico, South Africa and Turkey
- (b) Australia, Canada, Malaysia and New Zealand
- (c) Brazil, Iran, Saudi Arabia and Vietnam
- (d) Indonesia, Japan, Singapore and South Korea

Ans: (a)

Mains

Q. The new tri-nation partnership AUKUS is aimed at countering China's ambitions in the Indo-Pacific region. Is it going to supersede the existing partnerships in the region? Discuss the strength and impact of AUKUS in the present scenario. **(2021)**

Armed Forces Seek Higher Agniveer Retention



Source: IE

Why in News?

The Indian Armed Forces are seeking a significant upward revision in the retention percentage of **Agniveers** beyond the initially mandated 25% ceiling under the **Agnipath Scheme**.

- With the first batches of Agniveers who commenced training in early 2023 set to complete their four-year tenures, the three services have submitted proposals to the **Department of Military Affairs (DMA)** citing the critical need for preserving experienced manpower and capitalizing on the extensive training invested in new technological platforms.

What Has Triggered the Demand for Higher Agniveer Retention?

- **Proposed Retention Requirements of the Three Services:** The **Indian Navy** could seek retention

- of around 75% of its Agniveers, reflecting the highly technical nature of naval operations.
- The **Indian Army** and **Indian Air Force** may seek increasing retention to around 50%.
- However, the overall retention policy **currently remains capped at 25% across the three services.**
- **Preventing Immediate Manpower Shortfalls:** With a constant number of regular soldiers retiring every year, a strict 25% retention cap risks creating a critical, immediate vacuum in troop numbers.
 - While officials maintain that this structural deficit will stabilize over a few years, **military planners want a larger retention pool to bridge the transition safely.**
- **Lessons from Operation Sindoor:** Internal tactical feedback from **Operation Sindoor** highlighted that while **Agniveers performed exceptionally well in active environments**, long-term institutional experience remains irreplaceable.
 - The multiple field tenures and extensive training exercises of seasoned troops directly **translate into faster, more effective reactions during high-stakes operational crises.**
- **Technological Shift and Modernization:** Extensive **post-Operation Sindoor procurements** have introduced highly sophisticated weapon systems, modern equipment, and technical platforms into the armed forces.
 - Handling these complex technologies requires advanced, prolonged specialized training, making a **brief four-year exit cycle economically and operationally counterproductive.**
- **Technical Cruciality of Naval and Air Operations:** The demand for longer tenures is particularly acute for naval sailors and airmen.
 - Operating advanced warships, submarines, and complex aviation systems demands deep technical expertise that **can only be cultivated over extended durations.**

What is the Agnipath Scheme?

- **About:** Launched in June 2022, Agnipath is a pan-India, merit-based military recruitment program to enroll **personnel below the rank of officer (PBOR)** into the Army, Navy, and Air Force.
- **Rationale for Agnipath Scheme:**
 - **Youthful Military:** Reduce the average age of personnel from **32 to 26 years**, improving agility and combat effectiveness.
 - **Fiscal Sustainability:** Reduce pension liabilities and free resources for **defence modernisation and indigenous production**.
 - **Emerging Threats:** Build capabilities to counter **hybrid warfare, cyber threats, terrorism, and space and electronic warfare**.
 - **Nation Building:** Create a **disciplined and skilled youth workforce** supporting employment, disaster response, and **Viksit Bharat@2047**.
- **Tenure:** Recruits (known as Agniveers) serve for a duration of **four years**.
- **Age Limit:** 17.5 to 21 years (temporarily relaxed to 23 years for the inaugural batch).
- **Financial Package:** During their service, Agniveers receive a customized monthly package.
 - Upon completion of the four years, the 75% who are discharged receive a tax-free '**Seva Nidhi**' **package** (comprising their contribution and a matching government contribution, totaling around Rs 11.71 lakh), a skill certificate, and priority in certain **Central Armed Police Forces (CAPF)** and state police recruitments.
 - They also receive a non-contributory Life Insurance Cover of Rs 48 lakh.

- Provides Rs 44 lakh disability compensation and up to Rs 1 crore compensation for death during service.
- **Permanent Enrollment:** Currently, only up to 25% of each batch is selected for permanent enrollment in the regular cadre based on centralized, transparent, and objective organizational criteria.
- Agniveers selected for enrolment in the **regular cadre of the Armed Forces** must serve for a **minimum additional period of 15 years** and are governed by the existing service conditions applicable to regular personnel of equivalent ranks in the **Army, Navy and Air Force** .

What Steps are Needed to Reform the Agnipath Scheme?

- **Integration with 'Aatmanirbhar Bharat' & Defense Corridors:** Synergize the Agnipath exit cycle with the **Defense Industrial Corridors** (UP & Tamil Nadu).
 - Agniveers trained on advanced defense platforms should be provided direct transition pathways into the private defense manufacturing sector, R&D startups, and aviation maintenance.
 - This transforms them into the **technical backbone of India's indigenous defense ecosystem**.
- **Preserving the "Naam, Namak, Nishan" Ethos:** The Indian military's operational edge relies heavily on regimental cohesion and unit identity, which takes years to forge. **A purely contractual mindset threatens this fabric.**
 - Transition the terminology and psychological framing from a "Four-Year Contract" to an **"Extended Probationary Commission."** By framing the initial four years as a rigorous probationary assessment rather than a temporary stint , **units can better integrate recruits into the regimental ethos**, maintaining the psychological cohesion necessary for high-altitude combat and counter-insurgency operations.
- **Evidence-Based Review:** Complete the first recruitment cycle and evaluate the scheme using operational feedback, manpower trends and institutional assessments.
 - Allow the Army, Navy and Air Force to determine retention levels based on their distinct operational and technical requirements.
 - Prioritise Agniveers trained in critical technologies, specialised military platforms and operationally sensitive roles.
- **Institutional Oversight and Course Correction:** A policy of this magnitude requires dynamic legislative review, rather than relying solely on internal military feedback.
 - Institute a mandatory, biennial review by the Parliamentary Standing Committee on Defence. This ensures transparent auditing of the scheme's impact on combat readiness, defense expenditure, and demographic shifts, drawing on precedents set by structural review committees like the **Shekatkar Committee (2015)**.

Conclusion

Reforming the Agnipath scheme requires transitioning from a strictly fiscal calculation to a strategic human capital approach. By adopting flexible retention rates and enhancing welfare nets, India can achieve its dual objective of maintaining a young, agile military while preserving the deep tactical expertise required for modern, technology-driven warfare.

Drishti Mains Question:

Modern warfare requires technologically skilled personnel as much as a young and agile military force. In this context, analyse the challenges posed by short-term military recruitment under the Agnipath Scheme.

[Watch Video on YouTube: [▶ https://www.youtube.com/embed/i_7_5V4JPj8](https://www.youtube.com/embed/i_7_5V4JPj8)]

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

1. What is the Agnipath Scheme?

The **Agnipath Scheme** , launched in **June 2022** , is a pan-India, merit-based recruitment programme for enrolling Personnel Below Officer Rank (PBOR) into the Army, Navy and Air Force for a **four-year tenure** .

2. What is the existing retention policy for Agniveers?

Currently, **up to 25% of each Agniveer batch** can be enrolled in the regular cadre based on centralized, transparent and objective organizational criteria.

3. Why are the Armed Forces seeking higher Agniveer retention rates?

Higher retention is sought to prevent **manpower shortages, preserve institutional experience, recover investments in specialised training and operate technologically advanced military platforms effectively** .

4. What benefits are provided to Agniveers who exit after four years?

Exiting Agniveers receive a **tax-free Seva Nidhi package of around ₹11.71 lakh, a skill certificate, ₹48 lakh non-contributory life insurance cover during service and recruitment preferences in certain CAPFs and State Police forces** .

Cabinet Approves Additional Investment in NIIF



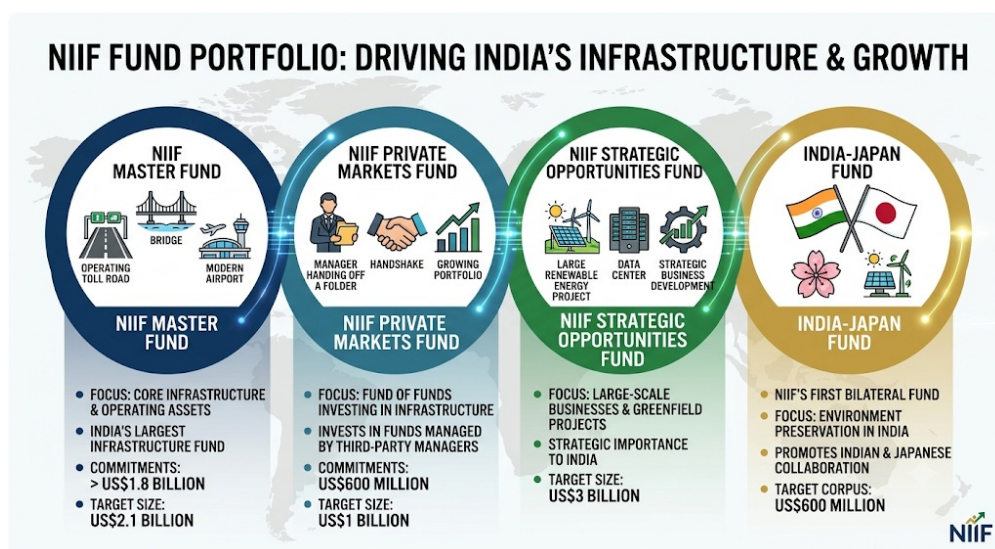
Source: TH

The Union Cabinet has approved an additional Government of India investment commitment of ₹30,000 crore in the **National Investment and Infrastructure Fund (NIIF)** , taking the Government's total commitment to ₹60,000 crore.

- A major portion of the additional commitment will support **NIIF Infrastructure Fund II**, which is proposed to have a **target corpus of about ₹30,000 crore** and will invest in transportation, energy,

National Investment and Infrastructure Fund (NIIF)

- **About:** Established in **2015** , NIIF was created as **India's sovereign-anchored investment platform** to attract global institutional investors and mobilise long-term capital for infrastructure development and other nationally important sectors.
- **Structure:** NIIF is professionally managed by NIIF Limited, with the Government holding a 49% stake and the remaining 51% mobilised from large global institutional investors.
 - It currently manages capital commitments of around **₹40,000 crore** and has returned nearly **₹12,000 crore** to investors through major portfolio exits.
- **Investor Participation:** NIIF has attracted investments from leading **sovereign wealth funds, pension funds, multilateral development institutions and domestic financial institutions** from countries including Australia, Canada, Japan, Singapore, the UAE and the United States.
 - **Australia's largest pension fund**, AustralianSuper, has recently announced an additional investment of **A\$500 million (about US\$346 million)** in India's NIIF, over and above its earlier commitment of **A\$240 million made in 2019** .
- **Role:** NIIF's investments are aligned with major national initiatives such as **PM Gati Shakti, Digital India , Make in India , FAME , PM E-DRIVE , India's climate commitments and Atmanirbhar Bharat** . It also advises government bodies on public-private partnerships, asset monetisation and strategic investment frameworks.
- **Significance:** The additional commitment is expected to attract further institutional and private capital, accelerate infrastructure creation, generate direct and indirect employment, strengthen sectors of national importance and support India's goal of becoming a **Viksit Bharat by 2047** .



Read More: [5th Meeting of Governing Council of NIIF](#)

SC to Refer Grounds of Arrest Issue to Larger Bench



Source: IE

The **Supreme Court of India** indicated that it might refer the legal question of whether investigating agencies are mandatorily required to provide the '**grounds of arrest**' in writing to an accused, to a larger Bench.

- The issue arose after the **Meghalaya High Court granted bail due to an incorrect BNS provision in the arrest memo** . The **State argued that a clerical error should not invalidate an arrest if the accused was informed of the reasons** , while the Supreme Court, citing conflicting precedents, indicated that the issue may require consideration by a **larger Bench** .
- **Conflicting Judgements on Written 'Grounds of Arrest':**
 - **Pankaj Bansal vs Union of India (2023):** The Supreme Court ruled that the **Enforcement Directorate (ED)** must mandatorily supply the grounds of arrest to an accused in writing in cases under the **Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), 2002** holding that oral communication is susceptible to factual disputes.
 - **Prabir Purkayastha Case (2024):** The Court extended this protection to the **Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act, 1967** stating that the right to receive written grounds of arrest is a **fundamental constitutional safeguard** .
 - The Supreme Court held that since **Articles 22(1) and 22(5) use identical language regarding communication of grounds** , the principles governing communication of grounds of **preventive detention under Article 22(5)** also apply to the communication of **grounds of arrest under Article 22(1)** .
 - **Mihir Rajesh Shah vs State of Maharashtra (Nov 2025):** The Court held that grounds of arrest must be provided in writing to the accused in **all cases** (including ordinary crimes under **BNS/IPC**) to give full effect to constitutional mandates.
 - **Dr Rajinder Rajan vs Union of India (April 2026)** : The Supreme Court also upheld the requirement **to furnish the grounds of arrest to the accused**.
 - **The Conflict - Vihaan Kumar vs State of Haryana (Feb 2025):** In contrast, a coordinate Bench ruled that while communicating the grounds of arrest is an indispensable safeguard, furnishing them *in writing* may not be "**practicable**" in every single case.
 - The Bench held that as long as the grounds are effectively communicated orally, the arrest is not necessarily vitiated.
- **Safeguards Against Arbitrary Arrest:** **Article 22(1)** guarantees that no arrested person shall be detained **without being informed, as soon as possible, of the grounds of arrest**, and ensures the right to consult and be defended by a legal practitioner of their choice.
 - **Section 47 of the BNSS, 2023** further mandates the immediate communication of the full particulars of the offence to a person arrested without a warrant.
 - **Section 48 of the BNSS, 2023** requires the person making the arrest to inform a **relative, friend, or any other person nominated by the arrested person** about the arrest and the place where the arrested person is being held.
 - The safeguard is rooted in **Article 21** , as knowledge of the grounds of arrest is essential for an

accused to **seek bail and effectively exercise the right to legal defence** .

Read more: [SC Directions on 'Digital-Arrest' Scams](#)

World Population Day



Source: TH

[World Population Day](#) is observed **every year on 11th July to raise awareness about global population issues** and their social, economic and developmental consequences.

- **Origin:** World Population Day traces its origin to **11th July 1987, when the global population reached approximately five billion**, drawing attention to rapid population growth and its consequences.
- **Establishment:** Responding to growing concerns over population-related challenges, the [United Nations Development Programme](#) formally established World Population Day in 1989.
- **Objective:** The day encourages discussion on **population-related challenges such as maternal health, poverty, unemployment, economic hardship, migration** and access to essential services.
- **Theme 2026:** The theme is **“Realizing the hopes and aspirations of young people - today and for the future,”** highlighting the need to understand and support young people’s choices regarding relationships, parenthood and family life.
- **Report:** The theme is based on the report **Lives, Choices and Futures: What Young People Want and What Shapes Their Decisions About Relationships and Parenthood**. It draws on the views of more than 108,000 internet-connected adults aged 18–39 across 73 countries.
- **Population Trend:** The global population took thousands of years to reach **one billion, but expanded sevenfold within the next two centuries**. It reached seven billion in 2011 and is projected to rise to around 8.5 billion by 2030 and 9.7 billion by 2050.
- **India’s Population Trend:** India (1.4 billion) remains one of the **most populous countries of the world** , representing nearly 17% of the world’s population. India's population is expected to **peak around 1.7-1.9 billion by the 2060s-2080s** before stabilizing or slowly declining.

Read More: [India’s Demographic Transition](#)

Navi Mumbai Airport Notified for Import of Drugs



Source: PIB

The **Union Ministry of Health and Family Welfare** has permitted the import of drugs through the newly inaugurated Navi Mumbai Airport to strengthen pharmaceutical logistics and facilitate trade.

- **About:** The notification was issued under the **Drugs and Cosmetics Act, 1940** after consultation with the **Drugs Technical Advisory Board(DTAB)** .
 - DTAB is a **statutory body** under the Drugs and Cosmetics Act, 1940, which advises governments on technical matters related to drugs and cosmetics regulation.
- **Expansion:** Rule 43A of the **Drugs Rules, 1945** has been amended to designate Navi Mumbai Airport as an authorised entry point for drug imports, raising the total number of approved road, rail, sea and **air entry points to 42.**
- **Logistics:** The new entry point is **expected to enable smoother and faster movement of pharmaceutical consignments** into the country.
- **Flexibility:** Importers will **gain an additional route for bringing medicines into India** , reducing dependence on existing entry points and improving supply-chain flexibility.
- **Significance:** The measure **seeks to improve trade facilitation and Ease of Doing Business** while maintaining effective regulatory oversight of imported drugs.

Read more: [Centre Amends Drugs Rules 1945 for Advanced Therapies](#)